Capability Survey of University Student Service Websites

What universities let a student do online, and what they do not

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Project: Smart University Website | IT Project I and II (BC362916 + BC362914) | Instructor: Dr. Aftab Alam Janisar | 6 October 2026

1. Why We Did Not Choose One University

We are not building this system for a single institution, so we did not pick one university to study. We are building an open reference implementation that any university can adopt. The backend, the agent layer, the APIs and the data model are the product. A university that adopts it supplies its own regulation documents, its own student data, its own identity provider and its own channel accounts, and changes the frontend and the database to match what it already runs. Nothing in the design depends on one university's rules.

That choice creates one obligation. If we are not studying a client, we still have to show that the problem is real. This report is how we show it. Instead of asking one university what it lacks, we measured what universities actually offer their students today, across 17 institutions in Thailand and abroad, and recorded every answer so that a reader can check any row.

2. Method

What we did. On 5 and 6 October 2026 we reviewed the public websites of 17 universities, 12 in Thailand and 5 international. For each university we answered the same seven capability questions, using public pages only, including registrar sites, library sites and official channel pages. We also reviewed published research on university chatbots, including Thai journal papers, to see how far existing assistants go.

Why these seven questions. The questions are the capabilities our system provides. We are not judging whether a university website is good in general. We are measuring whether a student can reach these services, see what happened to them, and do any of it by conversation. A university can score well on the first four questions and still fail the last three, and that is the gap we are investigating.

How to read a cross. A cross means the capability is not offered to students, or that we found no public evidence of it after a targeted search of that university's own sites. Where a cross is backed by an explicit statement, the note says so, for example a library that states its rooms are walk-in only. Since this survey measures what a student can discover and use from outside, a capability we cannot find is a capability the student cannot find either.

Limits we accept. We did not log in to any student portal, so a university may offer more inside its portal than is visible to us. We did not survey students, so this report measures what the systems do, not what students feel about them. Every row can be rechecked from the sources in Section 6.

3. The Seven Capability Questions

Code	Question	Why it matters
C1	Can a student submit a service request online, through a real form rather than an email with attachments?	The baseline. If this fails, everything after it fails too.
C2	After submitting, can the student see the state of that request without contacting staff?	Without a visible state, the student has to chase the office to find out what happened.
C3	Can a student book a room or a space online?	Shows whether the university can already handle a reservation with limited capacity.
C4	Is there an assistant or an official chat channel for student services?	Shows whether conversation is already an accepted channel at that university.
C5	Does that assistant answer from the university's own regulation documents, and show which rule the answer came from?	Separates an assistant that reasons over the real rules from one that replays written replies.
C6	Can that assistant complete a request or a booking inside the conversation, and then report its state?	The core capability of our project. This is the difference between answering and acting.
C7	Are these services reachable from one place, rather than from several separate systems?	Shows whether the student has to know which system does which job.

4. Results

✓ capability present ~ partly present ✗ not offered, or no public evidence found

University	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	C6	C7	Evidence and notes
Chulalongkorn (TH)	✓	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	Public request form, student number plus ID, QR payment. Documented process ends at payment and collection. Rooms booked in the CUNEX app. Registrar LINE account @regchula answers only.
Thammasat (TH)	✓	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	Requests on reg.tu.ac.th. Study rooms booked through QueQ, a separate product. Library LINE account @tulibrary for news and enquiries.
Mahidol (TH)	✓	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	Online proof-of-education system behind login, 1 to 5 working days then collect or post. Online syndicate room reservation, at the College of Management library. LINE account for registration queries.
Kasetsart (TH)	✓	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	Graduate request system for graduate students, available 24 hours, confirms by email only. Smart Study Room booking on a separate library system, at the Kamphaeng Saen campus library. Library enquiries by phone and LINE.
KMUTT (TH)	✓	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	Online document request form. **Library states KM Rooms are walk-in only**, so rooms cannot be booked online. Registrar LINE account @regiskmutt.
KMITL (TH)	✓	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	Digital transcript request behind login. Library room and area booking for students and staff. Library chat assistant "NongLifelong".
Assumption (TH)	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	Online transcript and certification request. Ready in 5 working days, or about a month after finals, with no status view. Study rooms exist but no online booking found. No assistant or chat channel found.
Bangkok Univ. (TH)	~	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	**"Online" means an email plus a photo of the bank transfer slip**, so there is no form. No room booking on the library site. Student questions answered on LINE.
Srinakharinwirot (TH)	✗	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	No online request route found on public pages. **A room booking system exists but is for teaching and administrative staff, not students.** Library LINE account for notifications.
KMUTNB (TH)	✗	✗	✓	✓	✗	~	✗	**Transcripts are requested in person at the counter**, or by downloading a form, then collected with a slip. Smartroom booking across three campuses, plus a second room system, k-room. NN Bot on LINE sends notifications and information.
STOU (TH)	~	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	STOU SISA app covers records, results and enrolment with mobile payment, but we found no confirmed online document request route. An open distance university, so there are no campus study rooms to book. LINE account with a published service manual, answered by staff.
Buriram Rajabhat (TH)	✓	✗	✗	✓	✗	~	✗	Online request menu inside the student system, 2 to 3 working days then collect or post. No room booking found. LINE chatbot across eight service areas, built on fixed intents and published as research.
NUS (SG)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	~	~	**Strongest in the survey.** NUService Hub tracks request status in one platform. Rooms in LibCal and Chope@NUS, letters in myEduRec, so still several systems. okOSA takes a status letter request in chat, then takes up to 4 working days and reports nothing back in the chat.
Melbourne (AU)	✓	✓	✓	~	✗	✗	✗	Candidature requests tracked in my.unimelb. Rooms in DiBS and computers in BookIT, two separate booking systems. Its ask.unimelb service is being retired.

Toronto (CA)	✓	~	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	Students generate some letters themselves in ACORN, but custom letters go through a separate eService with no status view. Rooms in LibCal. "Ask a Librarian" is a staffed chat shared across Ontario universities, not an assistant.
Manchester (UK)	✓	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	Online enquiry form for documents, fees and immigration, with no status view. Rooms in ResourceBooker, a separate system. "Reggie" answers quick registration questions.
Arizona State (US)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	Transcripts ordered through My ASU and fulfilled by Parchment, a third party, where the order status can be followed. Library rooms booked online. Sunny answers questions on housing, financial aid and advisors.
Present out of 17	**13**	**3**	**11**	**15**	**0**	**0**	**0**	**Counting full ticks only. Partial marks are counted in Section 5.**

5. What the Results Show

Universities are well equipped on the basics, and we say so plainly. 13 of 17 let a student submit a request through a real online form, 11 of 17 allow a room to be booked online, and 15 of 17 already run an assistant or an official chat channel. Any claim that universities have no online services is easy to disprove, so we do not make it. Four are exceptions: KMUTNB still takes transcript requests in person at the counter, Srinakharinwirot has no online route we could find, Bangkok University's "online" route is an email with a photo of a bank transfer slip, and at STOU we could confirm enrolment services but not document requests.

Visibility after submitting is rare. Only 3 of 17 show a student the state of a request without contacting staff, and all three are international. None of the 12 Thai universities do. A Thai student who submits a request is told how many working days to wait and then has to show up.

Conversation is already normal, but only for asking. 15 of 17 have a chat channel, and in Thailand it is almost always LINE. Students already accept chat as a way to deal with their university. The channel is there and is not being used to do anything.

> **The gap, stated precisely.** Across all 17 universities, **none** scored a tick on C5, C6 or C7. Not one assistant answers from the university's own regulation documents and shows the rule it came from. Not one completes a request or a booking inside the conversation and then reports its state. Not one offers these services from a single place. The three closest cases are partial: NUS takes a status letter request in chat but answers in four working days outside the chat, and the LINE bots at KMUTNB and Buriram Rajabhat run fixed scripts. Services exist, the chat channel exists, and nothing joins them.

6. Why the Assistants That Exist Do Not Close the Gap

The assistants we found are intent-based. A developer writes an intent such as "request transcript", gives it a set of example phrasings, and the system learns to route a message into one of those buckets and run the flow attached to it. These systems can perform real actions, so the limitation is not capability. The limitation is coverage: everything the assistant can handle was written down in advance by a person, and anything outside that list reaches a fallback reply. Adding a service means hand-building a new intent and a new flow.

Published work supports this. A 2025 review of university chatbots in higher education is framed around frequently asked questions, and the chatbot literature describes the main weakness as limited ability to go beyond the data the system was given. Thai universities have published several of these: an intent-based LINE service at KMUTNB, a chatbot covering eight service areas at Buriram Rajabhat, and a LINE-based graduate service system reported in IJECE. Each is built for one institution and one set of scripted intents.

What our project does differently. It retrieves from the university's published regulations, so it can answer a question nobody scripted and show the rule behind the answer. It selects an action by reading what each tool does, rather than by matching a trained intent, so new phrasings and combined requests still work. It completes the request, tracks its state, and reports back on the same chat channel the student started on. And it is built to be adopted rather than built for one campus.

7. Sources

Thailand. reg.chula.ac.th and chula.ac.th (CUNEX study rooms); reg.tu.ac.th, QueQ study room service and the @tulibrary LINE account; graduate.mahidol.ac.th and the CMMU syndicate room reservation system; grad.ku.ac.th and the Kasetsart library booking system; regis.kmutt.ac.th and lib.kmutt.ac.th (KM Rooms, walk-in only); reg.kmitl.ac.th and kllc.kmitl.ac.th (room booking and the NongLifelong assistant); registrar.au.edu and library.au.edu; bulinks.bu.ac.th and library.bu.ac.th; lib.swu.ac.th and roombook.swu.ac.th (staff only); acdserv.kmutnb.ac.th and smartroom.lib.kmutnb.ac.th; stou.ac.th and the STOU SISA application; oapr.bru.ac.th.

International. nusit.nus.edu.sg (NUService Hub), nus.libcal.com, nus.edu.sg/osa (okOSA and student status letters), nus.edu.sg/inside-nus (chatbots); gradresearch.unimelb.edu.au, library.unimelb.edu.au (DiBS and BookIT); sis.utoronto.ca, libcal.library.utoronto.ca, onesearch.library.utoronto.ca (Ask a Librarian); studentsupport.manchester.ac.uk, library.manchester.ac.uk, resourcebooker.manchester.ac.uk; registrar.asu.edu (Parchment), lib.asu.edu/studyrooms, ssi.asu.edu (Sunny); springshare.com/libcal.

Published research. A 2025 review of university chatbots for student support (Springer); an IJECE paper on automated information retrieval and services for graduate students over LINE; a Thai journal paper on an educational response and notification system using a LINE bot at KMUTNB; and a Thai journal paper on a chatbot application for student services at Buriram Rajabhat University.